

Survey Question

Interviewee: VP of Izakaya Operator from CP2

Question	Rating: Strongly Disagree (1) ~ Strongly Agree (5)	Summary
I think that I would like to use this system frequently	4	He sees AI as highly effective for "simple research" and "managing inventory efficiently".
I found the system unnecessarily complex	2	The manual's "plain language" and phase-based playbook align with his preference for clear business plans. +1
I thought the system was easy to use	4	The automated generation of regulatory checklists and financial snapshots simplifies complex data gathering. +1
I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system	2	While he trusts AI for market intelligence, he emphasizes that owners must still "physically go to the location" to verify AI findings.
I found the various functions in this system were well integrated	4	The manual successfully ties together "staffing, suppliers, equipment, and daily rhythms" into one operations module.
I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system	2	The manual uses consistent "guardrails" like the CPI-U and BLS wage data across sections. +1
I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly	5	The manual is explicitly written for "first-time owners" and provides a "beginner-friendly" playbook. +1
I found the system very cumbersome to use	1	He values automation for ordering and revenue performance, which this system facilitates via POS/KDS routing.
I felt very confident using the system	3	He would be cautious; he warns that AI cannot handle "dealing with clients" or "potential partners" yet.
I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system	2	The "Read once... then execute week-by-week" instruction makes the barrier to entry very low for a founder.

What part of the tool was most useful? The "Daily operations rhythm" and the mobile-friendly checklists. Being able to pull up the open/close checklists on my phone while physically in the kitchen or at the POS is a lifesaver for staying organized during a rush.

What part felt confusing? The "Financial Agent" section where it asks for "inputs" like CPI-U and FRB H.15. As an operator, I just want to know my food cost and rent; seeing macro-economic index numbers made me wonder how much detail I really needed to provide to get an accurate forecast.

Did the AI suggestions feel locally grounded? Extremely. It correctly identified the "Research Park area in UIUC" and pointed out that the campus already has a high density of Asian and Mexican options. It felt like it actually "knew" my neighbors.

Did the manual feel specific enough for a beginner founder? Yes. The "Phase-by-phase" playbook broke down the scary "launch" into manageable 2-week chunks. The advice to "be unmistakably good at a small set of items" helped me stop over-complicating my menu.

What information was missing? A more detailed "Allergen communication plan." The manual mentions it's needed, but didn't provide a template or specific local Illinois guidelines on how to post it for staff and customers.

Would you trust this tool for early restaurant planning? Why or why not? Yes, because it gave me a realistic budget range (\$75k–\$200k) based on real Champaign County wage data. It felt like it was grounded in math rather than just "vibes."